



MONTHLY UPDATE

Guinea-Bissau: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-08 · 4 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · DPI · INCLUSION

Summary of the month

Two rows moved, one of them a decree that had been waiting a year. On 8 August the government [approved a national interoperability regulation](#), the first movement on a draft the Council of Ministers had approved in July 2025; the announcement came from the regional programme that funds the work rather than from a gazette, and names no decree number or entry into force. Ahead of the 30 August referendum the electoral support office [handed the elections commission an updated register of 966,152 voters, unchanged from the last update](#), having [issued 25,146 replacement voter cards in a 30-day operation to 11 August](#). The month's registry work was replacing credentials rather than adding registrants.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The national digitalisation programme [launched nationally in August, at US\\$60m, covering connectivity, data protection, the digital economy and electronic government](#). It is the delivery vehicle the 2025-2030 strategy has lacked, and it arrives with a fund plan behind it: the [2026-2031 strategic and financing plan for the universal access fund](#), delivered in May after a review recommended restructuring the fund itself.

DPI

Data Exchange

[The government approved a national interoperability regulation](#), announced on 8 August 2026 by the World Bank-backed Western Africa Regional Digital Integration Program, which supports the work and presents the framework as Guinea-Bissau's contribution to the regional programme. A draft decree on the interoperability of public and private digital systems had been approved by the Council of Ministers on 10 July 2025 and had not moved since; the announcement names no decree number, no gazettal and no entry-into-force date, and the paired data-governance and cybersecurity decrees approved alongside it in 2025 remain where they were.

Registries

The register moved without the electorate changing. The electoral support office [handed the updated register to the elections commission in physical and electronic form for the 30 August referendum, recording 966,152 registered voters — unchanged from the last update](#), having also [issued 25,146 replacement voter cards in a 30-day nationwide operation from 13 July to 11 August through 51 brigades covering every region](#). So the month's work was replacing credentials rather than adding registrants, and no audit or de-duplication statement accompanies the handover.

Inclusion

Digital divides

The first measurement of adolescent access the base holds is academic rather than official. A [survey of 2,039 Bissau adolescents finds computer and internet access limited and unevenly distributed, skewed against girls and against pupils in state schools, with the pandemic having exposed rather than created the gap](#). It covers the capital rather than the country, and nothing official exists at any date to set beside it — which is why a doctoral thesis is the best evidence this report has on who among the young can get online.

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